

Restore and Improve Urban Infrastructure

Growing up in Vermont, Aidan Mayer has a special relationship with nature. In high school, he realized how massive cities are causing extreme strains on our planet, and he decided that no matter what career he ended up in it would be to help protect our environment. In college, at Worcester Polytechnic Institute, he took a course called Livable Cities and chose Architectural Engineering as his major. From there, Aidan applied for the Grand Challenges Scholars Program (GCSP) and researched how cities affect our day-to-day experiences. His study of urban humanities and enormous care for our world led to the discovery of an architect by the name of Bjarke Ingels.

Bjarke and his company BIG are building affordable, energy-efficient, gorgeous buildings across the world—buildings that solve issues such as climate change, affordable housing, and community engagement. Cities will only continue to increase in population and size as time goes on. Given 75 percent of all pollution in the world comes from cities and Aidan's love of the environment, he chose to focus on the global challenge of restoring and improving urban infrastructure. The GCSP was the perfect way to unite all of the information Aidan learned and will continue to learn to potentially make the lives of others easier and the future better.

Engineers Changing the World



Aidan Mayer
*Grand Challenges
Scholars Program*

"Knowledge is cool. Doing well in school is cool. Doing your homework is cool. The only thing I'd ask of you is to never give up. Growing up in today's day and age is a unique experience."

